



Fighting is an important part of animal life. They don't do it because they enjoy being *aggressive*, but to *ensure* the *survival* of themselves and their *offspring*.

DON'T COME ANY CLOSER

If a rival strays onto your turf, it's still worth avoiding a fight if you can, so it helps to have a few tricks available to scare off the opposition.

Stand up for yourself

Making yourself look bigger than your opponent is a useful tactic. Rearing up on your hindlegs makes you look taller, while turning sideways makes you look wider. If, like a crab or scorpion, you've got a huge pair of pincers to wave, even better!

MOON BEAR



Huff and puff

Puffing yourself up is another way to look larger than your rival. Birds fluff out their feathers and spread their wings or raise a crest if they have one. Some chameleons and reptiles inflate themselves with air, while elephants stick their ears out and trumpet loudly.

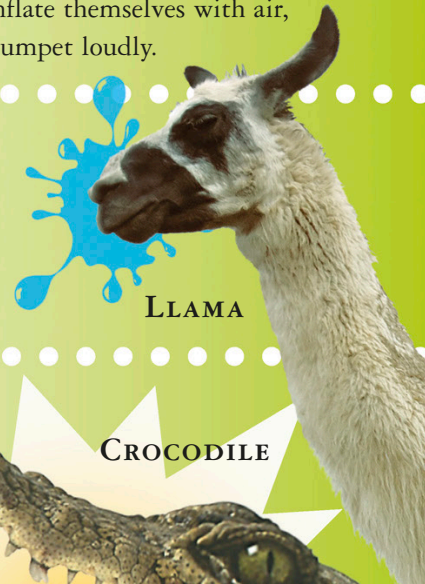
FRILLED LIZARD



Spit it out

Spitting isn't usually dangerous, but it can be unpleasant. Llamas are experts at hitting their target with partly chewed food. Fulmars (seabirds) go one step further and eject smelly vomit. Worst of all, cobras spit venom into an attacker's eyes.

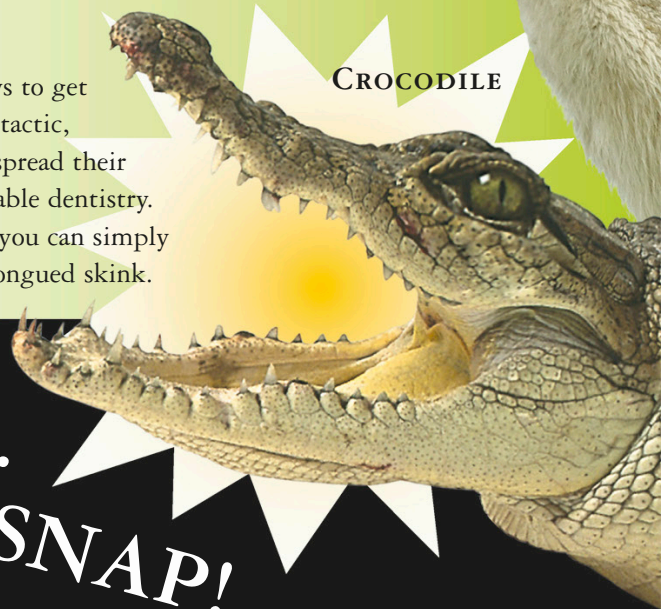
LLAMA



Show your teeth

Snarling, growling, and hissing are other ways to get the message across. Dogs and cats use this tactic, while pigs grind their teeth. Crocodiles spread their jaws wide open to display their formidable dentistry. Birds, too, open their beaks wide. Or you can simply stick your tongue out like the blue-tongued skink.

CROCODILE



SNAP!
SNAP!
SNAP!

